LLL-A-650D (GSA-FSS)
November 18, 1989
SUPERSEDING
LLL-A-00650C
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FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

ARCH AND CLIP BOARD FILES, COMPOSITION

HARDBOARD BACK

This Federal Specification is approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, New York, NY 10278, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers arch and clip board files for holding papers.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types. The arch and clip board files covered by this specification shall be of the following types, unless otherwise specified (See 6.3).

Type I. Arch board file with or without paper perforator, or indexes and cover, unless otherwise specified (See 6.3).

Type II. Clip board (See 6.3).

1.2.2 Sizes. For specific sizes by type, see 3.3, unless otherwise specified (See 6.3).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

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(Single copies of this specification, other Federal Specifications, and Commercial Item Descriptions required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston; New York; Washington, DC; Philadelphia; Atlanta; Chicago; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth; Houston; Denver; San Francisco; Los Angeles; and Auburn, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Commercial Item Descriptions, and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedure and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the below address or as directed by the contracting officer.)

U. S. Navy
Naval Publications and Forms Center
5801 Tabor Ave.
Philadelphia, PA 19120

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials. Materials shall be as specified, or, if not defined, shall be of any suitable material capable of meeting the performance requirements of this specification.

3.1.1 Composition Hardboard (See 6.2.1). Composition Hardboard used in the manufacture of arch and clip board files shall be Tempered (See 6.2.5) or Standard (See 6.2.4.); shall have a smooth (See 6.2.3), unfinished (See 6.2.6) surface on both sides; and shall be a plain board (See 6.2.2).

3.1.2 Sheet Steel. The corrosion resistant sheet steel shall be plain carbon steel, hot or cold rolled at the manufacturer's option. The sheet steel shall be finished as specified in 3.4.

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3.1.3 Steel Wire. The steel wire shall be plain, corrosion resistant carbon steel, and shall be finished as specified in 3.4.

3.2 Design and Construction.

3.2.1 Board. The board for the arch and clip board files shall be made of composition hardboard (See 3.1.1). The board shall be not less than 0.115, and not more than 0.155 inch thick. The board shall be smooth on both sides (See 3.1.1).

3.2.2 Type I, Arch Board File. The boards for the arch board files shall conform to the requirements stated in 3.1.1 and 3.2.1. An arch paper holder shall be securely fastened and centered (plus or minus 1/8 inch) to the top part along the upper edge of the board (See 3.2.2.1). When specified, a paper perforator shall be firmly attached to the bottom part along the lower edge of the board (See 3.2.2.2 and 6.3). An alphabetical index with a cover and metal compressor shall be furnished, unless otherwise specified (See 3.2.2.3 and 6.3).

3.2.2.1 Arch Paper Holder. The arch paper holder shall have a base with two metal arches. Each arch shall have a fixed and movable portion spaced on 2-3/4 inch centers. The fixed portion of the arch shall have a usable filing height of 2-1/2 inches, plus or minus 1/4 inch.

The base of the arch paper holder shall be made of 22 gage, minimum (.0299 inch) sheet steel (See 3.1.2). A concealed spring locking device within the base, or a single-action lever type locking device, shall firmly hold the movable portion of each arch when in either an open or closed position. The bottom of the base shall have, as an integral part, an extension with a 3/8 inch, plus or minus 1/8 inch diameter eye or cutout, extending sufficiently beyond the upper edge of the board to permit the board to be suspended from a flat vertical surface.

The movable portion of each arch shall be J-shaped and shall be made of 9 gage, minimum (.1495 inch) steel wire (See 3.1.3). The fixed portion of each arch shall be made of steel, and shall be either solid or hollow construction. The fixed portion of the arch shall be so designed to provide a suitable stop for the movable J-shaped wire arch when in closed position. When tested as specified in 4.4.1, the arches shall open and close easily and be in alignment when closed.

3.2.2.2 Perforator. When specified (See 3.2.2 and 6.3), the arch board file shall be equipped with a metal perforator having an overall height not greater than 1-1/4 inch above the face of the board. The perforator mechanism shall punch two 1/4 inch holes (plus 1/32 inch tolerance allowed), 2-3/4 inches center-to-center. The punches shall not stick to the dies, and perforations shall be free from torn or ragged edges and entirely punched out. The perforator shall perform satisfactorily when tested in accordance with 4.4.2.

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3.2.2.3 Index Cards and Cover. When specified (See 3.2.2 and 6.3), index cards and cover shall be furnished with the arch board file.

The index cards shall consist of at least 20 manila cards of graduated length, lettered, and arranged to form an alphabetical index along the right-hand margin of the file. The index cards shall be perforated so as to pass readily over any portion of the arch.

The cover shall be made of 0.020 inch pressboard or any commercially available pressboard capable of meeting the performance requirements of this specification. Unless otherwise specified (See 6.3), the cover shall not be wider than the width of the board, and not more than 1/2 inch less than the width of the board specified. The cover for size 9 x 14-1/2 inch board shall not be less than 11 inches long, and for size 9 x 17 inch board, not less than 13 inches long. Unless otherwise specified (See 6.3), length of cover for other size boards shall be in accordance with standard commercial practice. The cover shall be perforated so as to pass readily over any portion of the arch. Each cover shall be equipped with an adjustable metal compressor designed with a locking device to hold the cover at any point on the fixed portion of the arch.

3.2.3 Type II, Clip Board. The board for the clip boards shall conform to the requirements specified in 3.1.1 and 3.2.1. A metal spring clip shall be securely attached and centered (plus or minus 1/8 inch) along the upper part of the board (See 3.2.3.1).

3.2.3.1 Metal Spring Clip. The clamp of the clip shall not be less than 5-1/2 inches wide, and shall open a minimum of 1 inch. The clip shall be capable of holding securely any number of sheets of paper from one sheet to full capacity (one inch), when tested as specified in 4.4.3.

The base and clamp of the clip shall be made of 22 gage, minimum (.0299 inch) sheet steel, as specified in 3.1.2. The spring, base and clamp shall be firmly held in place by a rivet or an appropriate pin. The clamp shall be fabricated with a concavity having an eye or cutout 3/8 inch diameter, plus or minus 1/8 inch. The clamp shall not flex when pressure is exerted to open the clip. Clamp shall be tested in accordance with 4.4.3. The base of the clip shall have, as an integral part, an extension with a centered eye or cutout having a 3/8 inch diameter, plus or minus 1/8 inch. This extension shall extend sufficiently beyond the upper edge of the board to permit board to be suspended from a flat vertical surface. The exposed surfaces of the clip shall be smooth, and all corners and edges shall be rounded and smooth.

3.3 Board Dimensions. The dimensions for Type I Arch Board Files, and Type II Clip Boards Files shall be as specified in Table 1. A plus or minus tolerance of 1/8 inch will be permitted in the overall length and width of the boards.

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TABLE 1
BOARD DIMENSIONS (In inches)

TYPE I - SIZES	TYPE II - SIZES
7 x 12	9 x 12-1/2
9 x 14-1/2	9 x 15-1/2
9 x 17	9-1/4 x 11-3/4
	9 x 17
	13-1/4 x 11-1/4

3.4 Finish. All metal components shall be uniformly nickel, cadmium or zinc plated or coated, and shall have a shiny metallic finish. The finish shall be suitable to protect against corrosion. Contractor shall provide certification of plating conformance, upon request by the government.

3.5 Identification Marking. Unless otherwise specified (See 6.3), each arch and clip board shall be permanently and legibly marked with the name or trademark of the manufacturer.

3.6 Workmanship. Rivets, if used, shall be set in accordance with normal commercial practice, including but not limited to exhibiting a well formed, firm, flush seating. All other fasteners shall be firmly tightened. The arch paper holder, perforator, or clip shall be free from burrs, dents, rough or sharp edges, scratches, discoloration or other defects or imperfections which will impair serviceability and adversely affect the appearance or which might constitute a personal hazard to the user. The boards shall be free of rough or sharp edges, scratches, discoloration or defects or imperfections which may affect appearance, or may impair serviceability.

3.7 Recovered Materials. Recovered materials shall be used to the maximum extent practicable.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for Inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government (See 6.3).

4.2 Sampling. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, as described below:

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4.2.1 Sampling for Visual and Dimensional Inspection. A random sample of arch, or clip, board files shall be taken from each lot in accordance with inspection level S-3 with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) Of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one arch, or clip, board file.

4.2.2 Sampling for Preparation for Delivery. For examination, the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL Of 4.0 percent defective.

4.2.3 Sampling for Operational Tests. A random sample of arch, or clip, board files shall be taken from each lot in accordance with inspection level S-3 with an AQL Of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one arch, or clip, board file.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Visual and Dimensional Examination. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.1 shall be examined to determine that the arch, or clip, board files conform to the requirements of Section 3 and 6.1 of this specification.

4.3.2 Examination of Preparation for Delivery. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be examined to determine compliance with the requirements of Section 5.

4.4 Tests. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be subjected to the following performance tests. Any arch, or clip, board file in the sample failing one or more tests shall be considered defective.

4.4.1 Arch Paper Holder. Open and close the movable J-shaped arch 25 times, then examine it to determine compliance with the requirements in 3.2.2.1.

4.4.2 Perforator (When applicable). Six sheets of bond paper (20-lb, Chemical Pulp, Weight Basis-17x22-500) shall be perforated one at a time. Then, all six sheets of paper shall be assembled as one unit and perforated at different locations at least three times. The sheets shall be examined to determine compliance of the perforator with the requirements in 3.2.2.2.

4.4.3 Metal Clip Board. Open and close the metal clip sufficiently to allow a one (1) inch load of paper to be inserted and removed 25 times. Then, fill the clip board with paper 8x10-1/2, or 8-1/2x11-1/2 inches to the full capacity of one (1) inch, and hang the clip board against a wall for thirty minutes. Examine the clip board to determine compliance with the requirements in 3.2.3.1.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging/Packing. Unless otherwise specified (See 6.3), each arch board or clip board, file shall be braced or cushioned in accordance with normal commercial practice to prevent damage during multiple shipments, handling and storage. Precautions shall also be taken to prevent potential water damage.

The box shall be sealed to prevent accidental opening and shall be such to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination, complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation to be used.

5.1.1. Arch Board File. Six (6) arch board files shall be packed in a close-fitting fiberboard box.

5.1.2. Clip Board File. Twenty-four (24) clip board files shall be packed in a close-fitting fiberboard box.

5.2 Marking.

5.2.1 For Shipment to Civil Agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123. Bar code marking is required, unless otherwise specified (see 6.3).

5.2.2 For Shipment to Military Activities. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Bar code marking is required, unless otherwise specified (see 6.3).

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended Use.

6.1.1 Arch Board File. The arch board file is intended to hold perforated sheets of paper, and serve as a writing board.

6.1.2 Clip Board File. The clip board file is intended as a writing board, and enable user to readily add or remove sheets of paper.

6.2 Definitions.

6.2.1 Composition Hardboard: Inter-felted ligno-cellulosic fibers consolidated under heat and pressure in a hot-press to density of 31 pounds per cubic foot or greater. Other materials may be added to improve certain properties as stiffness, hardness, finishing properties, resistance to abrasion and moisture and to increase strength, durability and utility.

6.2.2 Plain Design: Uniform in appearance throughout and shall be free from visible variation in the surface plane.

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6.2.3 Smooth Surface: Free from defects including, but not limited to, voids, swells, chips, flakes, shavings, scuffs, dents, scratches or cracks.

6.2.4 Standard Hardboard: Hardboard of high strength and water resistance. It is in substantially the same form as when it comes from the manufacturing press, except for minor processing steps such as humidifcation and trimming to size.

6.2.5 Tempered Hardboard: Hardboard which has been impregnated with a siccative material, such as drying oil blends of oxidizing resin, and which is then stabilized by heat or which is processed with special additives during manufacture to impart substantially improved properties of stiffness, strength, hardness, and resistance to water and abrasion as compared to the standard hardboard.

6.2.6 Unfinished: A smooth, uniform texture (See 6.2.4); free from primer, filler, or sealant of any kind.

6.3 Ordering Data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents, as applicable:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type and size of board files required (See 1.2.1 and 1.2.2)
(c) Type I board files with paper perforator, indexes, cover, and metal compressor, if required (See 3.2.2).
(d) Index cover size, if other than 3.2.2.3
(e) Arrangements for inspection and inspection facilities, if different than 4.1.
(f) Packaging and packing for shipment, if other than Section 5.
(g) Identification marking, if other than 3.5.
(h) If bar code marking is not required (see 5.2.1 and 5.2.2).
(i) Special marking requirements (see 5.2.1 and 5.2.2).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE: DoD has no registered interest in revisions and amendments to this Federal specification until further notice.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA-FSS

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